Greek Tavli Cheat Sheet: Asodio Variant

A comprehensive reference for the custom, café-style quadrant evacuation rules

Core Objective

Navigate all 15 of your checkers around the board, moving them strictly as a complete unit **quadrant by quadrant**, while trapping your opponent's checkers to paralyze their movement.

Phase 1: The Entering Phase (The Loading Lock)

• **The Lock:** All 15 checkers begin completely off the active board. You cannot move any pieces forward until all 15 checkers have entered your starting quadrant.

• **The Asodio Roll (1-2):** Acts as the ultimate entry ticket. Allows you to immediately drop one checker onto the 1-spot and one checker onto the 2-spot of your starting quadrant.

• **Natural Doubles:** Rolling any natural double (e.g., 3-3, 5-5) also breaks the lock, letting you drop multiple checkers directly onto that specific number's spot.

• **Loading Strategy:** Use subsequent dice numbers to fill up your starting quadrant spots from 1 through 6.

Phase 2: The Quadrant Leap & Forward Freeze

• **Grid-by-Grid Advance:** Once all 15 checkers are inside the starting quadrant, your army is authorized to march forward sequentially through the remaining quadrants.

• **The Lock-In Rule:** When a checker enters a new quadrant, **it is frozen in place**. It cannot advance out of that quadrant until all other 14 checkers have successfully caught up and entered the same quadrant.

• **The Bottleneck Risk:** If a single checker lags behind in a previous quadrant, your entire forward army remains frozen and unable to move.

Phase 3: The Trapping (Plakoto) Mechanics

• **No Hitting:** Checkers are never knocked off the board or sent to a center bar.

• **Pinning:** If your checker lands on a point occupied by a *single*, lone opponent checker, you stack your checker directly on top of it to trap it.

• **Total Paralysis:** A trapped checker is completely frozen. Furthermore, because a player's army cannot leave a quadrant if any checker is left behind, pinning an opponent's lagging checker entirely freezes their whole forward force.

• **Ownership:** Once pinned, you own that point. Only your checkers may stack on top of it.

Quick Dice Reference Table

Roll Type	Effect During Entry Phase	Effect During Race Phase
Asodio (1-2)	Unlocks board; places checkers on spots 1 and 2.	Moves checkers normally by 1 and 2 spaces.
Natural Doubles	Unlocks board; drops checkers onto the matching spot number.	Moves checkers 4 times the value of the rolled number.
Standard Numbers	Places checkers on the rolled spot numbers (if unlocked).	Advances checkers forward grid-by-grid.

AI responses may include mistakes. Verify rules with your local players.